

# Reflection — Abasiono Mbat (24120111121)

Group G · Project G: SQLi Dump + Covert Exfiltration · Role: Documentation & Presentation · CYB 201 CA 1, October 2026

## What I did

I ran the full Group G attack chain end to end in a recorded terminal session: an nmap service scan of the target host, sqlmap detection of the injection in the DVWA SQLi page (confirming boolean-based blind and UNION-query techniques against the **id** parameter and fingerprinting the back-end), a full dump of the **users** table, cracking of all five MD5 password hashes with john and the rockyou wordlist, and finally hiding the dumped table inside a JPEG with steghide and recovering it byte-identical with **cmp**. My main deliverable for the group was the documentation side: I compiled the chain into our report, wrote the figure captions and recommendation section, and organised my own evidence under the required file-naming standard.

## What went wrong, and what I learned

Three things tripped me up, and each taught more than the steps that went smoothly. First, I set the terminal prompt to my matric number and thought the terminal had frozen — Ctrl+C didn't "fix" it. I learned that PS1 is just a persistent variable, that interrupting a command never restores the prompt, and that what looked like a bug was the logging convention working as intended. Second, john at first reported command not found, which turned out to be me typing into the wrong window. Third, john appeared to crack only two of five hashes; I had interrupted it reflexively during the prompt scare. Re-running it resumed from its progress file and finished the remaining three in seconds. The lesson I'll keep: when a tool "fails", check whether it actually failed or whether I interrupted, mis-typed, or pointed it at the wrong target — and that the audit log is the fastest way to find out.

## What it means for the real engagement

The rehearsal ran against a local practice target, so the same chain now has to be repeated in the lab Kali VM against the authorised lab DVWA, with the logged-in session cookie supplied to sqlmap. I now know exactly where each step can silently go wrong (wrong window, interrupted crack, missing cookie), which is what I'll be watching for when we run it for the submitted evidence.